

Notes on replication of Ajzenman

System

- OS: "openSUSE Leap 15.6"
- Processor: AMD Ryzen 9 3900X 12-Core Processor, 24 cores
- Memory available: 125GB memory
- Docker version 27.5.1-ce, build 4c9b3b011ae4
- stata version 18-mp-i (Docker image dataeditors/stata18-mp-i:2024-12-18)

Bugs

- Variable name: `ren ïentidad ent` was recoded as `ren entidad ent` (<https://github.com/larsvilhuber/replication-ajzenman-power-of-example/commit/95ea3eee0cec1ffd50ac6bf78180b66c849703a0>)
- Filename: one of 13 database files (`Data/Bases Madre/Homicides/DEFUN13.DBF`) has a different case, on a case-sensitive file system. All others are lower-case `dbf`. Manually modified the filename to be lower-case. (https://github.com/larsvilhuber/replication-ajzenman-power-of-example/blob/main/Corruption_Final/logs/logfile_30_Apr_2025-13_37_20-statauser.log#L811)
- Bug related to Stata version: `option contents()` not allowed since Stata 17; see [help table for updated syntax](#)

Structure

There are 143 `areg` regressions. The tables are not cleanly output.

Runtime: 1 hour 9 minutes (until bug)

Table 4:

To identify all coefficients from the separate regressions, I used `grep` to parse the Stata log file captured for `Table4.txt`:

```
grep -n "inter" Table4.txt | grep -v areg | awk ' { print $1, $2, $4, $5 } '
```

The output is:

```

      Coefficient  std.err.  t    P>|t|
25:  inter  .2588744  .0955364  2.71  0.008
87:  inter  .4995433  .1963678  2.54  0.013
219: inter  .5450504  .1686364  3.23  0.002
364: inter  .5299935  .1729945  3.06  0.003
```

```

618: inter .6067147 .1414045 4.29 0.000 <== Column 5
834: inter .1218765 .0556162 2.19 0.031
895: inter .1802902 .0995852 1.81 0.074
1027: inter .1839404 .0886252 2.08 0.041
1166: inter .1975147 .0725312 2.72 0.008
1323: inter .1856933 .0706579 2.63 0.010 <== Column 5
1538: inter .1106731 .0370288 2.99 0.004
1599: inter .2172922 .0713383 3.05 0.003
1731: inter .2479733 .0547653 4.53 0.000
1870: inter .2607372 .045871 5.68 0.000
2027: inter .2590473 .0523933 4.94 0.000 <== Column 5
2243: inter .0756975 .0211231 3.58 0.001
2304: inter .1179639 .0411609 2.87 0.005
2436: inter .1242549 .0370961 3.35 0.001
2575: inter .1416991 .027053 5.24 0.000
2732: inter .1398497 .0295395 4.73 0.000 <== Column 5

```

Reverse engineering variable names:

- **Uno** = "at least 1 incivic value"
- **Dos** = "at least 2 incivic values"
- **Tres** = "1st component PCA with 4 incivic values"
- **Count_Index** = "Count index (sum 5 incivic values)"

Checked variable definitions

- **Count_Index**:

```

** general index using the 5 vars
egen Count_Index=rowtotal(Indice_Tramposo Indice_Tramposo2 Confiable)
replace Count_Index = . if Indice_Tramposo ==. | Indice_Tramposo2 ==. |
Confiable ==.

```

- **Uno**:

```

Values.do:503:gen Uno = 0 if Count_Index <1
Values.do:504:replace Uno = 1 if Count_Index >=1
Values.do:505:replace Uno = . if Count_Index ==.

```

- **Dos**:

```

Values.do:509:gen Dos = 0 if Count_Index <2
Values.do:510:replace Dos = 1 if Count_Index >=2

```

```
Values.do:511:replace Dos = . if Count_Index ==.
```

- **Tres:**

```
pca Romper NotReturn Robar Tranza Confiable
predict pc_1
egen A = min(pc_1)
egen B=max(pc_1)
gen Dif=B-A
gen index=(pc_1-A)/Dif
ren index Tres
```

The variable of interest is `CorruptAfter(mtf)` and is the interaction between `Corrupt(mt)` (a dummy that scores 1 if the municipality *m* is corrupt during a particular period *t*) and `After(f)` (a dummy that takes on a value of 1 if the interview of the individual was performed before the month of February, when the reports were released, and 0 otherwise).

```
keep clave_mun year unautho Auditada Veces Corr_Acum Corrupt* una*
CorruptPast* C_menos1 C_menos2 C_1 C_2 lag* lead*
sort clave_mun Aud year
bysort clave_mun Aud : gen nro_auditoria = _n if Aud == 1
replace Auditada = 0 if Auditada ==.
replace nro = 0 if nro ==.
replace unau = 0 if unau ==.
...
gen Corrupt = 0
replace Corrupt =1 if unau >0
```

Test code:

```
include "config.do"
global cdname "$rootdir"

global cd_do "$cdname/Do"
global cd_data "$cdname/Data"

use "$cd_data/Longitudinal/Claves.dta", clear
** Delete obs that are not in the survey (but yes in the corruption dataset)
** merge with corruption again
merge 1:m clave_mun using
"$cd_data/Data_Corruption/TodosLosMuni_ConAudits_ConAlreadyAudited.dta"
keep if _merge !=2
desc
```

```
drop Corrupt
gen Corrupt = 0
replace Corrupt =1 if unau >0
tab Corrupt
```

Results

```
. tab Corrupt
```

Corrupt	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
0	1,370	85.31	85.31
1	236	14.69	100.00
Total	1,606	100.00	

Robustness checks

Definitions: "Count index": sum of five incivic answers; "At least 1": at least one incivic answer; "At least 2": at least two incivic answers; "PC": First component of a PCA (normalized to a 0–1 scale). The exact wording of the individual questions is as follows: (i) "The one who does not cheat, does not get ahead" (Completely Agree, Agree, Disagree, Completely Disagree); (ii) "Are you trustworthy?" (Completely Agree, Agree, Disagree, Completely Disagree); (iii) "Laws were made to be broken" (Completely Agree, Agree, Disagree, Completely Disagree); (iv) "How likely is it that you steal electricity from the public lines (illegally)" (1 to 100); (v) "How likely is it that you return a wallet with 500 pesos in it?" (1 to 100). In brackets: the estimated coefficients divided by the standard deviation of each variable.

Coding

Romper is coded 1 if respondent agrees or completely agrees. Median = Completely disagree.

Trustworthiness **Confiable** is reverse coded: it is set to 1 if the respondent disagrees or completely disagrees. Median = Agree.

Steal electricity is coded 1 if the respondents answer is above the mean. Mean = 6.58%.

Return wallet is coded 1 if the respondents answer is above the mean. Mean = 64.20%. Self-reported approx. probability: 81.30%

```
* break the rules

gen Romper = 0 if co01 !=. & co01 !=8
replace Romper =1 if inlist(co01,1,2)
```

```

* to get ahead in life need to cheat

gen Tranza = 0 if co03 !=. & co03 !=8
replace Tranza =1 if inlist(co03,1,2)

* trustworthy

**
gen Confiable = 1 if co05 !=8 & co05!=.
replace Confiable =0 if inlist(co05,1,2)

**

** steal electricity

su rg09_11 if rg09_11 >0
return list
gen Media_Robar = r(mean)
egen p90 = pctlile(rg09_11), p(90)

gen Robar = 0 if rg09_11 !=.
replace Robar = 1 if rg09_11 >Media_Robar
replace Robar = . if rg09_11==.

** not return wallet (with the opposite sign to make it compatible with the
rest)

gen complemento = 100-rg12_11 if rg12_11 !=.

su complemento if complemento >0
return list
gen Media_NotReturn = r(mean)
egen nrp90 = pctlile(complemento), p(90)

gen NotReturn = 0 if complemento !=.
replace NotReturn = 1 if complemento >Media_NotReturn
replace NotReturn = . if complemento ==.

```

Changes these to be more extremely "poor judgement": limited to **completely agree** (or reverse coded **completely disagree**), and to the 90 percentiles.

Results:

	Coefficient	std.err.	t	P> t		
25:	inter	-.0285057	.1090595	-0.26	0.795	
87:	inter	.0817852	.1547545	0.53	0.599	
219:	inter	.0600518	.1328355	0.45	0.653	
364:	inter	-.0051433	.1228959	-0.04	0.967	
618:	inter	.0994415	.1170965	0.85	0.398	<== Column 5
834:	inter	-.0390027	.0753067	-0.52	0.606	
895:	inter	.0107975	.1158709	0.09	0.926	
1027:	inter	-.0100146	.1081729	-0.09	0.926	
1166:	inter	.0306619	.1096336	0.28	0.780	
1323:	inter	-.0048173	.1015055	-0.05	0.962	<== Column 5
1538:	inter	.0059874	.0325353	0.18	0.854	
1599:	inter	.0412236	.0484137	0.85	0.397	
1731:	inter	.0416201	.0429528	0.97	0.336	
1870:	inter	.0695075	.0332821	2.09	0.040	
2027:	inter	.0520482	.0291082	1.79	0.078	<== Column 5
2243:	inter	.0414757	.0115817	3.58	0.001	
2304:	inter	.0687284	.0193136	3.56	0.001	
2436:	inter	.0613907	.0178548	3.44	0.001	
2575:	inter	.0658179	.0188798	3.49	0.001	
2732:	inter	.0599955	.0213624	2.81	0.006	<== Column 5

Strongly reduces magnitude (by about half), and significance of many of the coefficients (mostly the PCA remains significant, none of the others at conventional levels).